Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 3 expectations

Grade 3 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 3 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Draft: to be checked by a teacher before use.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.3.2, L.3.2a, L.3.2b, L.3.2c, L.3.2d, L.3.2e, L.3.2f, L.3.2g

A worked example

Correct this sentence: maryam said "i bought dates at the souq in sharjah"

1. Start the sentence with a capital letter: Maryam.
2. Names of people and places start with a capital: Maryam, Sharjah. The word I is always a capital.
3. Put a comma after said, then the speaker's exact words go inside quotation marks, with the full stop inside the closing marks.

Maryam said, "I bought dates at the souq in Sharjah."

Questions

1. Rewrite with correct capital letters: the souq in dubai opens at nine o'clock.

2. Which title is written correctly? A) The Falcon And The Desert B) The Falcon and the Desert

3. Add the missing commas: Noura lives in Sharjah United Arab Emirates.

4. Add the missing punctuation: Hamdan said I love dates cookies

5. Write the missing apostrophe: the camels hump was full of fat. (There is one camel.)

6. Write the missing apostrophe: the two girls bags were by the door. (There are two girls.)

7. Write each pair of words as one word with an apostrophe: did not, she is, we will.

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8. Which spelling is correct? A) beleive B) believe C) beleave

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9. Add the ending to the base word and write the new word: happy + ness, swim + ing.

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10. Here are guide words at the top of a dictionary page: camel and canal. Which word would you find on that page? A) cap B) camp C) cave

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11. Explain why Abu Dhabi and Friday begin with capital letters but city and day do not.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.3.1, L.3.1a, L.3.1b, L.3.1c, L.3.1d, L.3.1e, L.3.1f, L.3.1g, L.3.1h, L.3.1i

A worked example

Choose the right word: Yesterday Salem (runned / ran) to the metro station.

1. Yesterday tells us the action is in the past, so we need a past tense verb.
2. Run is an irregular verb: it does not add ed.
3. The past tense of run is ran.

ran (Yesterday Salem ran to the metro station.)

Questions

1. In the sentence "The tall falcon flew over the creek", name one adjective and one verb.

2. Write the plural of each noun: child, fox, baby.

3. Which is an abstract noun (a thing you cannot touch)? A) oryx B) kindness C) souq

4. Choose the right word: Maryam (buyed / bought) a bag of dates yesterday.

5. Rewrite in the future tense: Khalid walks to the metro station.

6. Choose the right word: The girl and her sister (is / are) at the mall.

7. Choose the right word: This tower is (taller / tallest) than that one. Then: Of the three towers, the blue one is the (taller / tallest).

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8. Find the adverb in this sentence: Noura carefully poured the karak.

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9. Choose the best joining word: We stayed inside (because / but) the sandstorm was strong.

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10. Choose the best joining word: Hind wanted to swim, (and / but / or) the pool was closed.

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11. Is this a complete sentence? "Because the bus was late." Say yes or no and explain, then fix it if needed.

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12. Join the two sentences into one sentence with the word although: Layla was tired. She finished her homework.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.3.1, W.3.1a, W.3.1b, W.3.1c, W.3.1d, W.3.2, W.3.2a, W.3.3, W.3.3a, W.3.3c, W.3.4, W.3.5

A worked example

Put these sentences in the best order to make a short story: (A) At last he waved to the fishermen. (B) Then a wooden dhow sailed into view. (C) Khalid went to the creek at sunrise.

1. A story needs a beginning, a middle and an end.
2. The beginning sets the scene: C, Khalid went to the creek.
3. The middle is what happens next (look for the word Then): B.
4. The end brings the story to a close (look for At last): A.

C, B, A

Questions

1. Write a first sentence that states your opinion on this topic: Should children walk to school when they can?

2. Give two reasons that support this opinion: Our school should have a daily reading time.

3. Join these two sentences with a linking word: Mangroves are important. They protect the coast.

4. Put these sentences in order: (A) Finally, the clean water is sent to homes. (B) First, seawater is taken into a desalination plant. (C) Next, the salt is removed.

5. Plan a short story about Maryam, who gets lost in the souq. Write a beginning, a middle and an end in note form.

6. You are writing about the Arabian oryx. Sort these facts into two groups: long straight horns, eats grass, white coat, lives in the desert.

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7. Make this sentence more exciting by adding detail: The dhow was nice.

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8. Which sentence does not belong, and why? Hamdan's falcon is brown. My bike is red. It hunts in the morning. It rests on a perch at night.

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9. Add a sentence of your own to the start of a story that tells where and when it happens, for a character named Salem.

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10. Write a closing sentence for a piece that says parks are good for families.

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11. Name three things to check when you proofread your own writing.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. The souq in Dubai opens at nine o'clock. (A sentence starts with a capital and the name of a city has a capital.)
2. B (in a title, the first word and the important words have capitals; small words such as and and the do not, unless they come first).
3. Noura lives in Sharjah, United Arab Emirates. (A comma separates the city from the country in an address.)
4. Hamdan said, "I love dates cookies." (A comma after said, quotation marks round his words, and a full stop inside the marks.)
5. The camel's hump was full of fat. (One owner, so the apostrophe goes before the s.)
6. The two girls' bags were by the door. (More than one owner with a plural ending in s, so the apostrophe goes after the s.)
7. didn't, she's, we'll
8. B, believe.
9. happiness (change the y to i before ness) and swimming (double the m before ing).
10. B, camp. (It comes after camel and before canal in alphabetical order.)
11. Abu Dhabi and Friday are the special names of one particular place and one particular day (proper nouns), so they take a capital letter. City and day are general words for any city or any day.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. Adjective: tall. Verb: flew.
2. children, foxes, babies
3. B, kindness.
4. bought (buy is an irregular verb).
5. Khalid will walk to the metro station.
6. are (two people, so a plural verb).
7. taller (comparing two) and tallest (comparing three).
8. carefully (it tells how she poured).
9. because (the storm is the reason).
10. but (the two ideas go against each other).
11. No, it is a fragment: it does not say what happened because of the late bus. Fix: Omar was late because the bus was late.
12. Although Layla was tired, she finished her homework. (Or: Layla finished her homework although she was tired. Although shows the two ideas go against each other.)

Section 3: Writing

1. A good answer states one clear opinion about the topic in a full sentence. Model: I think children should walk to school when they can.
2. A good answer gives two different reasons, each in its own sentence. Model: Reading helps us learn new words. It is also calm and fun.

3. A good answer joins them with a word such as because. Model: Mangroves are important because they protect the coast.
4. B, C, A (First, Next, Finally show the order).
5. A good answer has three parts with a character, a setting and a problem. Model: Beginning: Maryam looks at the spices and loses her aunt. Middle: She asks a shopkeeper for help. End: Her aunt finds her and they drink karak.
6. Group 1, how it looks: long straight horns, white coat. Group 2, food and home: eats grass, lives in the desert.
7. A good answer adds describing words and details that show the picture. Model: The old wooden dhow rocked gently on the shining blue water.
8. My bike is red. It is not about the falcon, so it should be taken out.
9. A good answer names the place and the time and introduces Salem. Model: One quiet morning, Salem walked along the beach in Fujairah.
10. A good answer returns to the opinion and ends the piece. Model: That is why every neighbourhood should have a park.
11. Any three of: capital letters at the start of sentences and names, a full stop or other end mark, correct spelling, apostrophes and commas, and that each sentence makes sense.